

Rubric for International Relations Theory Exam

Criteria	4 - Excellent	3 - Good	2 - Satisfactory	1 - Needs Improvement
Knowledge and Understanding	Demonstrates a comprehensive understanding of key concepts and theories; accurately references readings with critical engagement.	Demonstrates a solid understanding of key concepts and theories; references readings effectively.	Shows a basic understanding of key concepts and theories; some references to readings are present but lack depth.	Lacks understanding of key concepts and theories; minimal or no references to readings.
Analysis and Critical Thinking	Provides deep analysis, demonstrating critical engagement with theoretical material, including identifying nuances and complexities.	Provides coherent analysis, demonstrating basic engagement with theoretical material; identifies some contrasts and implications.	Offers limited analysis; engagement with theoretical material is superficial and lacks depth.	Provides little to no analysis; fails to engage with theoretical material meaningfully.
Application	Effectively applies theories to empirical examples or complex scenarios, integrating quotes and providing in-depth insights.	Applies theories to scenarios or examples in a straightforward manner; some integration of quotes is present.	Attempts to apply theories to scenarios but lacks depth; minimal integration of quotes.	Fails to apply theories to scenarios; little to no integration of quotes or examples.
Organization and Clarity	Clearly organizes ideas with sophisticated argument structure and logical flow; maintains coherence across analyses.	Organizes ideas clearly with logical flow; maintains coherence across essays and short answers.	Organization is present but lacks clarity; arguments may be confusing or disjointed.	Lacks organization; ideas are unclear and difficult to follow.

Reflection and Synthesis	Synthesizes perspectives to offer critical insights, connecting theoretical discussions to broader contexts with originality.	Reflects on theoretical discussions, connecting them to broader contexts; offers some insights.	Provides limited reflection; connections to broader contexts are minimal and lack depth.	Fails to reflect meaningfully; little to no connection to broader contexts or insights.
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